

In Depth Buzzerbeater Training Guide (+NT build guidance)

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Basics of Training

<https://www.buzzerbeater.com/community/forum/read.aspx?thread=144856&m=30>

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yN_OE74KkqY&t=189s&ab_channel=BubblesBuzzerBeater

Many of the basics covered in those videos won't be in this guide. A quick summary is: 1. Training Single Position (or double position when the training has no single position) is the most effective way to train great players.

2. Make sure your player gets full training minutes at the position you are training:

- 18-19 year old needs 45+
- 20-26 year old needs 48+
- 27 year old and older needs 40+
- 3. Younger players train faster
- 4. Different heights train different skills faster
- 5. Players train at the position they play, not the position they are listed as. You often will play the player you are training at different positions over time to get them the skills they need

This guide will cover some other stuff that the videos talk about, but in more detail

1) Building a Training Plan

When building a training plan for your players, there are a few things you need to consider:

1. The Elastic Effect
2. The salary increases from skills being trained
3. The Potential and Age of your Player
4. The height of your player
5. How much skill increase comes from each type of training

Buzzer-manager.com and the salary estimation tool can be helpful when estimating #2 and #3, however it is not 100% accurate on salary and usually underestimates how strong a player can be for their potential.

The Elastic Effect

The Elastic Effect is used to describe how some skills will train faster on your player if certain other skills are higher. For example, if your player has really high Handling, but low Outside Defense, when you train Outside Defense it will train faster due to the high handling. The Guide to BuzzerBeater describes this as:

“According to the RiP88 dictionary of BB terms, [the elastic effect] described as “The increased or decreased speed a skill will train at when its corresponding skills are higher or lower relative to the said skill.”

It is important to note something that The Guide to BuzzerBeater does not. The elastic effect that different skills have on each other is not the same. For example, as stated before, having higher handling will lead to quicker outside defense training. However, higher handling does not lead to quicker inside shot training or jump range training (or if it does it is very minimal). So when does the elastic effect matter? Luckily some smart people in the past were able to estimate the effect and created this nice chart:

TrainingSkill	JS	JR	OD	HA	DR	PA	IS	ID	RB	SB
Jump_Shot		-0.0045			0.0211					
Jump_Range			0.0371							
Outside_Defense				0.0332						
Handling			0.0116			0.0103				
Driving	0.0296					0.0129				
Passing				0.0259						
Inside_Shot	0.0125		-0.0067					0.0289	0.0057	
Inside_Defense							0.0153			-0.0052
Rebounding		-0.0046						0.0371		
Shot_Blocking								0.0197		

Here is how to interpret this:

The skill listed in the left column is the skill that you would be looking to train. You can then see the corresponding effect that other skills have on its training by looking at its corresponding row.

For example, if I am training Outside Defense then I can see the effect of Handling is 0.0332 in green.

This means the handling will increase the speed of Outside defense. More specifically, for each level of handling above driving you get a 3.3% increase in training (estimated).

Using these “elastic effects” you can plan out your training in such a way that you maximize the positives on this chart. More detail on this later.

Salary increases from each skill

Buzzer-manager’s salary estimation tool is still one of the easiest to use ways to estimate how your players salary will change as you go about your training plan. However, it isn’t 100% accurate and tends to overestimate primary skills and underestimate secondary skills.

This forum post lists the estimated coefficients from the formula that bb-manager uses:
<https://www.buzzerbeater.com/community/forum/read.aspx?thread=160760&m=16>

Here is a simpler way of looking at it:

Position	High-Cost Skills	Medium Cost Skills	Low Cost or Nearly Free Skills
PG	OD, HA, PA	JS, JR, DR, RB	IS, ID, SB
SG	JS, JR, OD , RB	HA, PA	DR, IS, ID, SB
SF	JS , JR, OD, ID, RB	PA	HA, DR, IS, SB
PF	JS, IS, ID, RB ,	SB	JR, OD, HA, DR, PA
C	IS, ID, RB , SB	JS	JR, OD, HA, DR, PA

I have also bolded the skills that are the very highest. Not every skill in each column is the same weight, but it is any easy way of viewing it. It is important to note that while some skills are cheap on salary, they may still have an impact on a player’s potential cap.

The Potential and Age of your Player

You should consider both the potential and age of the player you are training when forming your training plan. Most of the plans in this guide will focus on training an 18-year-old to their maximum potential, but you can also use it to form a training plan for a player that is older and has already received some training.

The tools that currently estimate when a player reaches their potential can be pretty inaccurate. However, buzzer-manager’s salary estimation tool remains the go to for most managers. However, you should note:

1. Potential has sub-levels. If your player is listed as MVP potential this could mean they have 9.0 potential, or 9.99. This will affect when they get capped (skill training slows down).
2. Buzzer-manager generally underestimates potential. You can likely train your player even further than what buzzer-manager lists as 100% of their potential. However, it does give you a good ballpark.
3. There is both a soft cap on a players training and a hard cap. Once you hit the soft cap you will see training start to slow down in its speed. When you hit the hard cap you will likely not be able to get much more training at all.

Since you can get a PA 18-year-old for extremely cheap, it is generally recommended that you train a player with at least that potential.

Height + How much skill increase comes from each type of training

Height is an important part of how you plan to train your player as different heights train different skills differently. As a general rule, the shorter a player is the better they are for being trained as a guard. The taller they are the better they may be for being trained as a center. Small Forwards and Power Forwards tend to be best at a medium height. However, certain builds may do better with specific heights depending on what you are training the most.

The best resource for both how height affects training as well as how much training comes from each type of training, is the #training-graphs channel in discord that all USA users have access to. To conserve space, I will not copy it all here, but know that the estimates come from a level 4 trainer and don't factor in a boost from the elastic effect.

MOST IMPORTANT TAKEAWAYS FROM TRAINING GRAPHS

Shorter players get better training from the following

- Jump Shot Forwards (JS, JR, IS)
- IS when training 1v1 F
- OD when training pressure
- JR when training Outside Shooting

Taller players get better training from the following:

- All training at C as well as PF/C (IS, ID, SB, REB)
- Passing
- 1v1 Guard (JS, HA, DR)

Building Your Training Plan

Knowing the above facts about training can help you develop a plan. Factoring in your players height, potential, and age you can think about what type of player they can best develop into. From there you can plan out the training order based on the elastic effect as well as salary increases from skills going up.

If you aren't planning on promoting and don't want your players skills to go up, then it might work best to train secondary skills that cost less. When you do want to promote then you may be training some of the more important skills that cost a lot of salary. Additionally, it is easier to train out of position in lower divisions or when you aren't as focused on competing.

There are multiple tools available for calculating out your trainee's growth.

2) Infrastructure (Gym and Training Court)

From the Game Manual on Cross Training:

"Another important thing to keep in mind is cross training. This method emphasize each skill as part of becoming a more complete basketball player, and make reference to every skill. Thus, improvement in driving is related not just to related skills (like handling), but also more weakly to unrelated skills (like shot blocking). For the average player in the game, this will result in approximately 10% slower training in their primary skill than before, and additional training in other skills approximately corresponding to that 10% loss. A particularly well-rounded player will continue to receive cross-training but will see a much lower reduction in primary skill training, while a particularly one-dimensional player will see a larger loss. Although players will always receive a set amount of cross-training, it is difficult to predict which unrelated skills will improve on a weekly basis."

The Gym gives you 1, 2, or 3 more cross training slots based on level. Some builds may not require a gym, but it is needed for most NT builds and U21 players.

Training Court helps players train FT. Here is the estimates I have found (they may be out of date):

- Level 3 should grant a pop in FT every 6 weeks in an 18yo and a pop every 9 weeks in an over30yo - Level 2 should grant a pop in FT every 7 weeks in an 18yo and a pop every 11 weeks in an over30yo - Level 1 should grant a pop in FT every 11 weeks in an 18yo and probably a pop every 20+ weeks in an over30yo

A level one TC is highly suggested. FTs are important and it is difficult to train them without a TC since you are sacrificing weeks which are valuable for other skills. A level 2 or 3 can be beneficial depending on your financial situation.

3) Trainer/Youth Trainer Effect

Different levels of trainers give different amount of training. Here is the best estimates for each level that I have come across:

Level 7: 100%

Level 6: 99%

Level 5: 97%

Level 4: 93%

Level 3: 86%

Level 7 could very well be underestimated due to the lack of data. Based on these amounts it is highly suggested that you get a level 4 trainer minimum, especially due to how cheap they are. Level 5 can give you an edge, especially if found for cheap. Level 6+ is suggested for training NT players since over the course of 7+ seasons it will result in a large payout in TSP.

Other managers have mentioned how each level you go up for a trainer is equal to about 1 pop per season.

I have a hard time finding estimates for the Youth Trainer effect, but it is suggested to have one for your players ages 18 to 19. A level 4-5 youth trainer can generally be found for cheap. Once again, for training NT it is suggested to have a YT level 6+.

4) Training a NT Player

What do I need to train a NT player?

The majority of NT builds it is suggested to have the following:

- Level 6+ Trainer (Level 5 is the minimum)
- Level 6+ Youth Trainer
- Level 1-3 Gym (preferably 3)
- Level 1+ TC

Many builds may be accomplished with a level 5 trainer, but you will be training for a longer time and may fall behind, some don't require a gym (the lower TSP builds). However, the better the trainer and infrastructure, the better the chance your player will be NT level. Any NT player you are likely going to be training throughout their career until they are fully capped.

Your player will need the following:

- Hall of Fame Potential (some builds a highly specialized MVP may do)
- 50+ TSP on guards/small forward at 18 years old
- In general, it is better to have the high starting skills for those that train slower at that height (outside defense on tall players, inside defense and inside shot on short players)

It is important to be in contact with the NT coach about your training plan to see the best route for making your player into a NT player.

One of the biggest things with training a NT player is to plan ahead. If you neglect secondary and out of position training early on, then you will have a hard time fixing it later. Additionally, you need to train in a way that maximizes the elastic effect.

What if I can't afford their salary?

The nice thing when training a NT player is that they are going to be really good, even for their high salary. With sufficient planning you can get to a high enough division as you train them in order to afford their salary. They also bring in a high amount of merchandise equivalent to about 15% of their salary. On my team (Wasted Potential) I brought in \$290k in merchandise each week from having 3 NT players. This was with no merchandise store or arena design.

If you end up having to sell them then you will likely sell for a lot of money if they are still young.

NT Builds

I will list two possible builds for each position that would be NT level players. These builds are better than current players as our current NT talent have been lacking. You can definitely specialize from these build types; we need a variety of NT player types to run many different tactics. If you want to build a truly generational talent, then you will have to go above and beyond these builds.

The training plans don't need to be followed exactly. They are just given in a simple way meant to maximize elastic effects. If you have to deviate slightly from them then that is fine and feel free to specialize your player.

Stamina/FT training not included. Ideally when the build is finished the player gets to 8+ stamina.

Point Guards

🇺🇸 Inside Point Guard

Estimated Salary: \$ 213 451	Jump Shot: colossal	Jump Range: prominent
Age: 25	Outside Def.: legendary (22)	Handling: colossal
Height: 200 cm	Driving: colossal	Passing: prodigious
Potential: Hall of Famer	Inside Shot: legendary	Inside Def.: sensational
Potential limit: 100%	Rebounding: inept	Shot Blocking: respectable
	Stamina: mediocre	Free Throw: wondrous
	Experience: prominent	Skills sum: 148 (105 43)
	PG: 15.94 SG: 16.26 SF: 14.88 PF: 13.85 C: 13.14	

generated by /www.buzzer-manager.com

Ideal attributes of trainee: Below 6'5" Hall of Fame Potential. High starting skills in Passing, Outside Defense, Inside Shot. Low starting rebounding.

Generic Training Plan

1v1 F Until HA/DR are 16

JSF Until JS is 18
 IS Until IS is 20
 JSF if necessary to get JS to 19
 OD to 20
 Passing to 15
 Alternate OD/Passing to 22/16



Combo Guard

Estimated Salary: \$ 247 542

Age: 25

Height: 200 cm

Potential: Hall of Famer

Potential limit: 100%

Jump Shot: legendary

Outside Def.: legendary (21)

Driving: legendary

Inside Shot: legendary

Rebounding: respectable

Stamina: proficient

Jump Range: tremendous

Handling: legendary

Passing: marvelous

Inside Def.: tremendous

Shot Blocking: respectable

Free Throw: legendary

Experience: colossal

Skills sum: 156 (109|47)

PG: 16.34 | SG: 16.65 | SF: 15.57 | PF: 14.83 | C: 14.31

generated by /www.buzzer-manager.com

Ideal attributes of trainee: Below 6'5". Hall of Fame Potential. High starting skills in Passing, Inside Shot.

Possible Training Plan
 1v1 F Until HA/DR are 16/17
 JSF Until JS is 19
 IS Until IS is 20
 Outside Shooting/JS to 20 JS/13 JR
 OD to 20
 Passing to 14
 Alternate OD/Passing to 21/15

Shooting Guards

🇺🇸 Score First Guard

Estimated Salary: \$ 193 529	Jump Shot: legendary (22)	Jump Range: marvelous
Age: 25	Outside Def.: legendary	Handling: legendary (21)
Height: 200 cm	Driving: legendary (22)	Passing: sensational
Potential: Hall of Famer	Inside Shot: legendary	Inside Def.: prolific
Potential limit: 100%	Rebounding: inept	Shot Blocking: respectable
	Stamina: mediocre	Free Throw: wondrous
	Experience: prominent	Skills sum: 154 (112 42)
	PG: 15.42 SG: 15.98 SF: 14.49 PF: 13.75 C: 13.1	

generated by /www.buzzer-manager.com

Ideal attributes of trainee: Below 6'4". Hall of Fame Potential. High starting TSP (50+). Low starting rebounding.

Possible Training Plan
 1v1 F Until HA/DR are 17/18
 JSF Until JS is 19
 IS Until IS is 20
 OD to 19
 Outside Shooting/JS to 22 JS/15 JR
 Passing to 12
 OD to 20



Defensive Guard

Estimated Salary: \$ 224 178

Age: 25

Height: 200 cm

Potential: Hall of Famer

Potential limit: 100%

Jump Shot: legendary

Outside Def.: legendary (23)

Driving: legendary (21)

Inside Shot: colossal

Rebounding: respectable

Stamina: proficient

Jump Range: tremendous

Handling: legendary (22)

Passing: sensational

Inside Def.: tremendous

Shot Blocking: respectable

Free Throw: legendary

Experience: colossal

PG: 16.33 | SG: 16.78 | SF: 15.41 | PF: 14.68 | C: 14.11

Skills sum: 157 (111|46)

generated by /www.buzzer-manager.com

Ideal attributes of trainee: Below 6'4". Hall of Fame Potential. High starting TSP (50+).

Possible Training Plan

1v1 F Until HA/DR are 17

JSF Until JS is 18 or 19

IS Until IS is 19/20

ID as needed (do not spend too much time training it on short players)

OD to 20

Outside Shooting to 20 JS/13 JR

Passing to 12 or 13

OD to the moon!

Small Forwards

🇺🇸 Outside Small Forward

Estimated Salary: \$ 173 356	Jump Shot: legendary	Jump Range: sensational
Age: 25	Outside Def.: legendary	Handling: legendary
Height: 200 cm	Driving: legendary	Passing: sensational
Potential: Hall of Famer	Inside Shot: legendary	Inside Def.: prodigious
Potential limit: 100%	Rebounding: respectable	Shot Blocking: proficient
	Stamina: mediocre	Free Throw: wondrous
	Experience: prominent	Skills sum: 156 (104 52)
PG: 15.23 SG: 15.69 SF: 15.33 PF: 15.32 C: 15.11		

generated by /www.buzzer-manager.com

Ideal attributes of trainee: Near 6'6". Hall of Fame Potential. High starting TSP (50+).

Possible Training Plan

ID to 12

1v1F or 1v1G Until HA/DR are 18

or switch the first two steps

JSF/JSG Until JS is 18

IS Until IS is 20

OD to 20

ID to 16

JSG to 20/12 JS/JR

Passing to 12

Round out skills

🇺🇸 Inside Small Forward

Estimated Salary: \$ 196 857	Jump Shot: phenomenal	Jump Range: prominent
Age: 25	Outside Def.: legendary	Handling: legendary
Height: 200 cm	Driving: legendary	Passing: prolific
Potential: Hall of Famer	Inside Shot: legendary	Inside Def.: colossal
Potential limit: 100%	Rebounding: proficient	Shot Blocking: proficient
	Stamina: mediocre	Free Throw: wondrous
	Experience: prominent	Skills sum: 156 (99 57)
	PG: 14.89 SG: 15.25 SF: 15.67 PF: 16.26 C: 16.37	
	generated by /www.buzzer-manager.com	

Ideal attributes of trainee: Near 6'7". Hall of Fame Potential. High starting TSP (50+).

Possible Training Plan

1v1F or 1v1G Until HA/DR are 17

ID to 15/16

JSF/JSJ Until JS is 16

IS Until IS is 20

OD to 19/20

ID to 19

Passing to 11

JSF to 18 JS

Round out skills as needed (rebounding, shot blocking, passing)

Power Forwards



Combo Forward

Estimated Salary: \$ 212 735

Age: 25

Height: 200 cm

Potential: Hall of Famer

Potential limit: 100%

Jump Shot: marvelous

Outside Def.: stupendous

Driving: legendary

Inside Shot: colossal

Rebounding: sensational

Stamina: mediocre

Jump Range: respectable

Handling: legendary

Passing: marvelous

Inside Def.: legendary

Shot Blocking: proficient

Free Throw: wondrous

Experience: prominent

PG: 15.03 | SG: 14.76 | SF: 15.97 | PF: 16.75 | C: 17

Skills sum: 154 (94|60)

generated by /www.buzzer-manager.com

Ideal attributes of trainee: Near 6'7". Hall of Fame Potential. High starting TSP (50+). High starting OD.

Possible Training Plan

Option 1:

1v1F to HA/DR 14

OD until 15/16

PA until 14/15

1v1 G to HA/DR 19

ID to 19

RB to 12

IS to 19 (JSF as well if more JS is desired)

Round out any other skills as needed

Option 2

1v1G to HA/DR 17

OD until 15/16

PA until 14/15
 ID to 19
 RB to 12
 IS to 19 (JSF as well if more JS is desired)
 Round out any other skills as needed


Power Forward

Estimated Salary: \$ 232 819	Jump Shot: tremendous	Jump Range: average
Age: 25	Outside Def.: wondrous	Handling: legendary
Height: 200 cm	Driving: legendary	Passing: marvelous
Potential: Hall of Famer	Inside Shot: legendary	Inside Def.: colossal
Potential limit: 100%	Rebounding: wondrous	Shot Blocking: prominent
	Stamina: mediocre	Free Throw: wondrous
	Experience: prominent	Skills sum: 151 (88 63)
PG: 14.31 SG: 13.78 SF: 15.7 PF: 16.96 C: 17.38		

generated by /www.buzzer-manager.com

Ideal attributes of trainee: Near 6'8". Hall of Fame Potential. High starting TSP (50+). High starting OD.

Possible Training Plan

1v1G to HA/DR 16 (can mix in 1v1F depending on the JS of the player)

OD until 13

PA until 14/15

ID to 18

RB to 14

IS to 20

Round out any other skills as needed

Centers



Shot Blocking Center

Estimated Salary: \$ 194 142

Age: 25

Height: 200 cm

Potential: **Hall of Famer**

Potential limit: 97% - 100%

Jump Shot: **respectable**

Outside Def.: **marvelous**

Driving: **tremendous**

Inside Shot: **respectable**

Rebounding: **legendary**

Stamina: **proficient**

Jump Range: **inept**

Handling: **marvelous**

Passing: **phenomenal**

Inside Def.: **legendary**

Shot Blocking: **legendary (22)**

Free Throw: **legendary**

Experience: **colossal**

Skills sum: **141 (72|69)**

PG: 14.7 | SG: 13.86 | **SF: 14.97** | PF: 14.84 | C: 14.96

generated by /www.buzzer-manager.com

Ideal attributes of trainee: Near 6'9". Hall of Fame Potential. High starting TSP (50+). High starting OD.

Possible Training Plan

HA to 12/13 (Can also do 1v1 G)

OD as high as you can manage

PA to 18

ID/SB to 20

Rebounding to 20

ID/SB to the moon



Generic Center

Estimated Salary: \$ 264 179

Age: 25

Height: 200 cm

Potential: Hall of Famer

Potential limit: 100%

Jump Shot: proficient

Outside Def.: sensational

Driving: wondrous

Inside Shot: phenomenal

Rebounding: prodigious

Stamina: mediocre

Jump Range: mediocre

Handling: prodigious

Passing: prodigious

Inside Def.: colossal

Shot Blocking: wondrous

Free Throw: wondrous

Experience: prominent

Skills sum: 139 (72|67)

PG: 13.35 | SG: 12.69 | SF: 15.02 | PF: 16.33 | C: 16.91

generated by /www.buzzer-manager.com

Ideal attributes of trainee: Near 6'10". Hall of Fame Potential. High starting OD.

Possible Training Plan

1v1G/1v1F to HA/DR 14 or 15 (1v1G is better on tall players, but you don't want high JS on this player type so go 1v1F if needed to prevent JS from going much higher than 9)

OD until 12

PA until 17

ID to 17/18

SB to 14

Reb to 16

IS to 18

Round out any other skills as needed

Checkpoints

The best way to know if your player is on track is to reach out to the NT coach, however, here are some very basic TSP checkpoints that line up with most builds

Beginning Age 21 – 100 TSP

Beginning Age 24 – 130's TSP (might be lower on some bigs)

Age 26 – Very close to final build

If your player is lower TSP than the checkpoint, but has higher IS/ID, then they may still be on track. Not all builds will line up with these numbers.